

UREL-1103, UREL-1106, UREL-1202
Subject & Verb Agreement

Choose the right verbs in the following sentences. *First try yourself then match with the answers.*

Sentences with options	Remark
1. The boys in the room is/are studying. 2. The freshness of these vegetables attract/attracts the customers. 3. The freshness of these vegetables is/are attractive. 4. The beauty of many places of Bangladesh is /are attractive to the tourists. 5. The study of languages is/are very interesting. 6. Several theories on this subject have /has been proposed. 7. The view of these disciplines varies/vary from time to time. 8. The danger of forest fires is/are not to be taken lightly. 9. The effects of that crime is/are likely to be devastating. 10. The fear of rape and robbery has/have caused many people to flee to the cities. 11. The picture of soldiers bring/brings back many memories. 12. The quality of these recordings is/are not very good. 13. The effects of cigarette smoking have/has been proven to be extremely harmful. 14. The use of credit cards in place of cash have/has increased rapidly in recent years. 15. Living expenses in this country as well as in many other countries is/are all time high. 16. The levels of intoxication vary/varies from time to time.	In all of these sentences the verb follows the headword which is usually placed before prepositional phrase like 'of many place' on television' etc.
<i>Answers: 1. are, 2. attracts, 3. is, 4. is, 5. is, 6. have, 7. varies, 8. is, 9. are, 10. has, 11. brings, 12. is, 13. have, 14. has, 15. are, 16. vary.</i>	
17. The actress along with her manger and some friends is/are going to a party tonight. 18. The Prime Minister with all members of her cabinet has/have arrived. 19. Mr. Robbins accompanied by his wife and children is/are arriving tonight. 20. My father together with my brothers and sisters have/has come to see me off. 21. John along with twenty friends is/are planning a party. 22. Mr. Jones accompanied by several members of the committee have/has proposed some changes of the rules. 23. My classmates as well as I am/are not willing to suspend the classes.	The verb will follow the first subject when two subjects are put together by 'with, together with, along with, accompanied by, as well as, etc.
<i>17. is, 18. has, 19. is, 20. has, 21. is, 22. has, 23. Are</i>	
24. Everybody who has/have not purchased a ticket should be in this line. 25. Something was/were under this house. 26. Somebody is/are waiting outside. 27. Nobody like/likes a liar. 28. No problem has/have ever been so difficult. 29. Anybody who has/have lost his ticket should report to the desk. 30. Nobody works/work harder than John does.	A subject formed with <i>any, no, some or every</i> is singular, so the verb with it should also be singular.
31. After she had perused the material, the secretary decided that everything	

was/were in order 32. Anything is/are better than going to another movie tonight. 33. Everybody who has/have a fever must go home immediately.	
24. has. 25. was. 26. is. 27. likes. 28. has. 29. has. 30. works. 31. was. 32. is. 33. has.	
34. None of the student was/were present. 35. No examples was/were relevant. 36. None of the money was/were spent. 37. No example was/were cited. 38. No money was/were necessary. 39. No students has/have passed. 40. None of the students have/has submitted the assignment.	None of/no before a non- count noun or singular noun takes singular verb, and before a plural noun takes plural verb.
34. was. 35. were. 36. was. 37. was. 38. was. 39. have. 40. have	
41. Either/Neither of two brothers has/have done this. 42. Either/Neither of Rafiq and Hasib was/were present. 43. Neither/Either of these two machines works/work tremendously. 44. Either Shihab or his classmates was/were reported about it. 45. Neither Maria nor her friends is/are going to class today. 46. Neither John nor his friends are/is going to the beach today. 47. Either John or his wife make/makes breakfast each morning.	Neither/Either with of is singular and is used with singular verb, but with nor/or can join both singular and plural nouns. The verb will follow the second subject.
41. has. 42. was. 43. works. 44. were. 45. are. 46. are. 47. makes	
48. The organization is/are known worldwide. 49. The family has/have gone to Nepal to enjoy vacation. 50. The group works/work with best planning. 51. The committee has/have reached a final decision. 52. The committee is/are trying to enforce their wide different views. 53. The jury is/ are divided in their verdicts. 54. The jury has/have reached a consensus. 55. The majority believe/believes that the law is oppressive. 56. The majority of the building was/were affected during the earthquake. 57. The majority of the students have/has passed. 58. The public was/were dispersed by the police. 59. The crowd is/are moving towards the barricade.	Collective noun is singular and is used with singular verb. But when there is indication that all the members are not meant together it is termed as noun of multitude, which is plural and takes plural verb. The word majority/minority will be singular if they are used without another noun. If they are used with a plural noun they are regarded as plural.
48. is. 49. has. 50. works. 51. has. 52. are, 53. are. 54. has. 55. believes. 56. was. 57. have. 58. was. 59. Is	
60. Twenty-five dollars was/were required for the job. 61. Fifty minutes is/are not enough time to finish the test. 62. Forty dollars has/have already been spent here. 63. Thirty miles mean/means a whole distance of thirty miles. 64. Fifty kgs is/are a heavy weight for this weak man. 65. Sixty miles was/were covered with one liter of petrol.	The phrases of time, distance and weight indicate the whole of these things. So they take singular verbs.
60. was. 61. is. 62. has. 63. means. 64. is. 65. was.	

66. A number of students is/are going to the class picnic. 67. The number of days in a week is/are seven. 68. A number of applicants has/have already been interviewed. 69. The number of residents who have been questioned on this matter is/are quite small. 70. A number of reporters was/were on the bureau last night. 71. The number of students who have withdrawn from class this quarter is/are appalling. 72. A number of boys come/comes here everyday to play football. 73. The number of crows in this town is/are increasing day by day.	<i>A number of (few) is plural while The number is singular.</i>
66. are. 67. is. 68. have. 69. is. 70. were. 71. is. 72. come. 73. is.	
74. There is/are a storm approaching. 75. There have/has been a number of telephone calls today. 76. There was/were an accident last night. 77. There works/work one hundred labors in our factory. 78. There lies/lie a big pond in front of our house. 79. There has/have been too many interruptions in this class. 80. There lives/live a saint in our village.	<i>There is followed by singular verb when the following noun is singular, and plural verb when the noun after is plural.</i>
74. is. 75. have. 76. was. 77. work. 78. lies. 79. have. 80. lives	
81. The Founder and President is/are coming. 82. The Founder and the President was/were present. 83. Bread and butter was/were his favorite food. 84. Slow and steady win/wins the race. 85. Time and tide wait/waits for none. 86. Early to bed and early to rise makes/make a man healthy. 87. My relative and friend has/have come.	<i>When two nouns refer to one thing, one person or one idea or two things are meant together singular verb should be used.</i>
81. is. 82. were. 83. was. 84. wins. 85. waits. 86. makes. 87. has.	
88. Gulliver's travels is/are a famous book. 89. Star Wars was/were a successful film. 90. The Arabian Nights attract/ attracts the reader.	<i>A title is singular even the word is plural.</i>
88. is. 89. was. 90. attracts.	
91. Each boy and each girl was/were dressed a new dress. 92. Every man woman and child was/were charmed. 93. Every man, woman and child in the village pray/prays for his well being. 94. Every hour and minute brings/bring its call for duty.	<i>Two or more singular subjects preceded by each or every take singular verb.</i>
91. was. 92. was. 93. prays. 94. brings.	
95. The news is/are true. 96. The wages of sin are/is death. 97. His whereabouts is/are known to the police. 98. Politics is/are a business of his life. 99. Physics is/are a branch of sciences. 100. Mathematics make/makes him nervous.	<i>Words like news, wages, whereabouts, physics etc. are singular.</i>
95. is. 96. is. 97. is. 98. is. 99. is. 100. makes.	
101. More than one student has/have been selected. 102. More than two persons was/were killed. 103. More than one boy was/were present there. 104. There is/are lots of work to do. 105. There is/are a lot of water in this pond. 106. There is/are a lot of problems in this job.	<i>More than one is singular, but more than two is plural. Fractions and lots of before singular noun is singular, but before plural</i>

107. Lots of people think/thinks so. 108. Two thirds of the job has/have been completed. 109. Three fourths of the students come/comes to the class. 110. Two fourths of the building has/have been painted white.	noun is plural.
101. has. 102. were. 103. was. 104. are. 105. Is 106. Are 107. think. 108. has. 109. come. 110. Has	
111. Many a student fears/fear English. 112. A great many persons has/have been found waiting there. 113. A good many boys was/were present in the class.	Many a is singular, but a great many is plural.
111. fears. 112. have. 113. were.	

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